



FUNDAMENTALS OF OPEN SOURCE IT AND CLOUD COM...

WHAT IS LINUX?

Linux as an Operating System

Reasons to Use Linux

Select "Expand" to learn more about why you should use Linux.

What are some of the reasons why you should use Linux?

Free

Close ^

Linux is based on open source, freely available software:

1. No recurring licensing fees
2. No initial cost for many distributions
3. No corporate fees

Stable

Close ^

Linux is a very stable operating system; it is unusual for it to crash:

1. Not prone to crash
2. Performance does not deteriorate over time

Secure

Close ^

Linux runs in many security levels, from relaxed security on your private network to government required standards:

1. Linux viruses are not as prevalent as those on other operating systems
2. Optional (still free) security enhancements from the NSA can be enabled

3. Free antivirus software if required

Maintainability

[Close ^](#)

The Linux package management tools make it easy to update, add and remove software packages:

1. Updating Linux distributions is straightforward and easy
2. Uses public repositories maintained by various Linux providers
3. If desired, the repository can be company-internal

Runs on a wide range of hardware

[Close ^](#)

Almost any Intel x86 or later, AMD, ARM, RISC-V and even mainframes can run Linux:

1. Large systems
2. Old systems
3. Refrigerators
4. Televisions
5. Phones
6. And many more

Easy to use

[Close ^](#)

The Linux command line is available on almost every installation, but users may never see it or need it:

1. Command line interface
2. Several graphical desktop environments
3. Easy to switch Desktop environments

Support

[Close ^](#)

1. It is community-supported
2. Purchased support from some commercial Linux vendors is also available (Red Hat, SUSE, Canonical, etc.)

Open source

Close ^

Linux is the largest open source project in the world, with the largest number of contributors.

1. Everyone has access to view and modify Linux
2. Linux uses the GPL2 license